

Are Chatbots the Future of all Digital and Non-Digital Businesses?



Chatbots have developed tremendously. These serve many purposes in contemporary businesses by making interactions effective and productive.

Technological advancements in the marketing world have enabled new dimensions of personalisation. Chatbots are one of those technologies that act as a conversational agent between brands and users. The process of good customer service is changing dramatically with the help of chatbots. Now, customers do not have to call or email customer care to get the required information. Almost every brand is now using chatbot service on their website, applications, blogs and software for better customer support. Chatbots can interact with users through text or audio—a time-saving activity for any customer-centric organisation. Chatbots can have a different personality and they can create a persona that seems to be real.

How chatbots work

Chatbots have varieties of functionalities that are used for various purposes, but the intent behind it all is to make the interaction simple for users. There are different types of chatbots, which are discussed below.

Voice bots: Voice bots are designed to interact with humans to answer questions and display vocalised keywords. These are becoming popular among all other chatbots, as they assist users just by recognising the voice. Some popular examples are Google Assistant, Siri and Amazon Alexa.

Informational bots: Informational bots provide essential information just by drawing information from their internal or external data to help users with an appropriate answer. Users

can set their travelling calendars, get live sports scores, weather reports and a lot more information from such informational bots. Examples include Cricbuzz, Cricket next, Google Alerts and so on.

Conversational bots: Conversational bots are of various types. These communicate with humans—some are led by humans, while others lead humans. These bots have a variety of conversational styles and forms. Businesses have begun to set up conversational bots for such activities as marketing, sales, company calendars and more, which save time and cost. One example is Facebook Messenger.

There are many more types of bots already in play and many will soon emerge in the future, and will make the market digitally more forward.

Chatbots provide round-the-clock service—interactive conversations with an automated program are operational 365 days a year, 24 hours a day. New-age consumers desire immediate results and lean on businesses that deliver high-speed services. Majority of consumers do not care who is responding as long as they get quick help and assistance.

Consumers are not the only ones who have benefitted from chatbots. In fact, businesses are also saving money as chatbots allow prompt resolution of basic customer queries. In addition to cost savings, chatbots have reduced workload of humans and allowed them to focus on creating new ideas/products, instead of spending time resolving clients' concerns.